

## What is Temp and %TEMP% Folder in Windows?

Both **Temp** and **%TEMP%** refer to **temporary folders** used by Windows and applications to store **temporary data**. These files are not meant to be permanent — they are created for short-term tasks and can be deleted safely in most cases.

### 1. What is the Temp Folder?

The **Temp folder** is a **physical folder on your system** where:

- Windows stores temporary files while installing or running apps
- Browsers and software save **caches, logs, or update files**
- Installers extract data before completing setup

 Typical Paths:

- C:\Windows\Temp (used by the Windows system)
- C:\Users\<YourUsername>\AppData\Local\Temp (user-specific)

### 2. What is %TEMP%?

%TEMP% is an **environment variable** in Windows.

It automatically **points to your personal temp folder**:

pgsql

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%TEMP% → C:\Users\<Username>\AppData\Local\Temp

 Type %TEMP% in **Run (Win + R)** → it opens your **user-specific temp folder**.

 It's safer to clean %TEMP% than C:\Windows\Temp (which is system-level).

## What Gets Stored in Temp and %TEMP%?

| Stored Item Type | Example |
|------------------|---------|
|------------------|---------|

|           |                                          |
|-----------|------------------------------------------|
| App cache | MS Office, Photoshop, Chrome cache files |
|-----------|------------------------------------------|

|                    |                                |
|--------------------|--------------------------------|
| Installation files | Setup files temporarily stored |
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|--------------------|---------------------|
| Logs & error dumps | When programs crash |
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|---------------------|---------------------------|
| Print Spooler files | While printing a document |
|---------------------|---------------------------|

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|--------------|-------------------------|
| Session data | Web apps, game sessions |
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